

Dallas Center-Grimes Community School District

Board Report from Madison Melchert, Activities Director

Date: May 6th, 2026

Spring Activities

The momentum of our spring season is at an all-time high as we move into the final stretch of the school year. Our student-athletes and performers are not just competing; they are setting new benchmarks for excellence at DCG.

Girls Soccer currently holds an impressive 7–1–1 record, the team is preparing for a major challenge at the upcoming Soccer Classic, featuring key matchups against top opponents like Waverly-Shell Rock.

Boys Soccer continues to hold the #1 State Ranking in Class 3A with a 10–2–1 record. We wrap up conference play on May 12th and are gearing up for the postseason. Notably, the IHSAA has adjusted the state format; all 3A Quarterfinal games will be held at Indianola Stadium before advancing to the State Tournament in Des Moines.

Boys Tennis is having an historic season. A program that is still relatively new to our district now has the opportunity to tie for the conference title. The strides in improvement are a testament to our coaching staff's dedication to the kids and DCG.

Both Track & Field programs placed 3rd at the Little Hawkeye Conference Meet. Additionally, both will travel to Waukee Northwest for their State Qualifying meet. In Class 4A the stakes are high: the top two in each event and the next 12 best marks statewide qualify for the State Meet at Drake Stadium on May 21, 22, and 23. Notably, we will be competing in the morning session of the state meet for the next two years.

Girls Golf has three regular-season matches remaining, the team is focused on regional play at Southeast Polk. Their scoring has been incredibly consistent, and they are firmly in the hunt for a State tournament berth.

The curtain closed on our production of *"Our Town"* this past weekend. It was a joy to see the passion our students poured into this classic, resulting in a professional and moving performance that resonated with our entire community. I don't think anyone left with a dry eye in the house.

Baseball and Softball have also started this week. This is a busy time of year when seasons and celebrations overlap. It speaks volumes about our coaches and their abilities to put students first when sharing amongst many different activities.

Culture & Identity

At DCG, our core values aren't just words on a poster; they are actions we witness every day. This month we were honored to receive the Spirit Spotlight Award from Musco Lighting, a recognition stemming from our environment at the Girls State Basketball tournament. The Musco team traveled to our campus this week to personally present the check. This honor perfectly encapsulates our commitment to being:

- **Inclusive & Supportive:** Creating an environment where every student and fan feels they belong.
- **Passionate:** Bringing unmatched energy to every arena we enter.
- **Collaborative & Innovative:** Finding new ways to engage our community and represent the Mustangs with pride.

Seeing our fans and students recognized on a state level is a highlight of the year.

Operations & Finances

We remain deeply grateful for the behind-the-scenes work that allows our students to shine. Our collaboration with the operations and business teams continues to be innovative and supportive.

- **Field Prep:** Operations has been working tirelessly to transition our fields for baseball and softball. A special thank you to Sean Shatava, who dedicated his Saturday to assist the softball team with field clean-up.
- **Leadership:** Travis Donahue remains instrumental in district planning. His leadership regarding facility rentals is unmatched, providing a streamlined and professional process for our community.
- **Fiscal Stewardship:** Michelle Wearmouth has been an invaluable guide during my first year. Her expertise with RFPs and contracts ensures that we are working "smarter" with our funds to directly benefit our kids while ensuring DCG is well-protected and prepared for the future.

Personal Highlight

My personal highlight continues to be witnessing this special community step up. The Booster Club has provided tremendous support, and it is exciting to see a rejuvenated FOFA (Friends of Fine Arts) trying new things and expanding their reach.

The volunteerism we've seen at our seven scheduled track meets has been overwhelming and serves as a constant reminder of why DCG is such a unique place. Additionally, I've had the chance to connect with several young coaches and directors who are DCG graduates. Seeing our alumni return to pour back into the programs that shaped them is the ultimate evidence of the long-term impact our activities team is making.

Looking Ahead

As I wrap up my first year as your Activities Director, I am filled with pride for what we have accomplished. I look forward to presenting to the Board next month to provide a comprehensive look at our department's progress. We are building a very special team here, and I can't wait to showcase our collective success. Adam Juhl and Katelyn Cain have been working very hard this year and are tremendous teammates. I am excited to showcase our efforts to you all.

Madison Melchert

Activities Director

Dallas Center–Grimes High School